Life of a Disciple

Luke Johnston's selected teaching, writing or development sample; original bylines and citations retained.

Full teaching files

life of a disciple	*2 pages*
life of a disciple student	*1 pages*
life of a disciple GROWTH	*2 pages*
life of a disciple GROWTH STUDENT	*1 pages*
LIFE OF A DISCIPLE CLOSENESS TO GOD	*2 pages*
LIFE OF A DISCIPLE CLOSENESS TO JESUS STUDENT	*1 pages*
life of a disciple suffering (2)	*2 pages*
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Teacher and student editions are components of this one portfolio entry.



The Life of a Disciple

1) Throughout this series we will dive into exactly what the life of someone who is a disciple of Jesus Christ looks like. We will examine the characteristics of this life, what this life entails, the hardships of this life, and even look at some examples of disciples in the Bible and examine their lives. Today we will see that disciples are heavily involved in the spiritual warfare going on every day. They are not just passively involved, but are consciously and **purposefully** involved because they are following Jesus Christ and desire to please God.

2) DISCIPLES ARE INVOLVED IN A SPIRITUAL WAR

i) The moment you receive Jesus Christ as your Lord and Savior, you are entered into an eternal battle between God and the Devil for souls and an eternal throne. This warfare is serious and immediately gives you enemies who are trying to take you out

ii) Everyone from the moment of their birth is involved in some way in the war, whether they want to be or not. But disciples who follow God will be front line soldiers in this war and they are actively involved in the war

b) The War

i) The war is being fought between the two ultimate forces in this universe: God and the Devil
(1) There are 2 sides in this war and you are on one or the other

ii) The war is being fought for the throne of God (Isa. 14:12-13; Rev. 12:7-9)

iii) The war is being fought for the souls of men (The life of Job; 2 Pet. 3:9; 1 Pet. 5:8)
(a) Kingdom of God and Kingdom of Heaven; the 2 thrones

c) Our Enemies

i) The war is being fought by 3 enemies
(1) The Devil (1 Pet. 5:8; Job 41:22)
(2) The World (1 Jn. 2:15-17; Rom. 12:2; James 4:4; 2 Tim. 2:2-4)
(3) The Flesh (Gal. 5:17; 1 Pet. 2:11; Rom. 7:18-25)

d) Our Weapons/Armor (1 Cor. 10:3-6; Eph. 6:10-18)

i) Truth (vs. 14)

ii) Righteousness (vs. 14)

iii) Preparation of the gospel of peace (vs. 15)

iv) Faith (vs. 16)

v) Salvation (vs. 17)

vi) Word of God (vs. 17)

vii) Prayer (vs. 18)

e) Our Goal in the War

i) Assist God in his pursuit for the throne

(1) One day we will be a part of the takeover of this world with Jesus Christ when he gains the **physical** throne of this world (Rev. 19:11-15; Jude 1:14-15)

(2) Today we are a part of the pursuit of God for the **spiritual** throne of each and every soul in this world. We help God in the war to reign in the lives of individuals through sharing the gospel and discipling others to do the same (Luke 17:20-21; 1 Cor. 6:19-20)

3) We all are in this war from the moment we are born, whether we desire to be or not. The difference in a Christian and a disciple is that a disciple is completely and totally aware of the war, the enemy, the tactics, the weapons, and fully given to the mission of the war. They are seeking each and everyday to be good soldiers of Jesus Christ in order to bring glory to God and win souls in this spiritual war between God and the Devil. We must be prepared to **fight** each and every day if we are going to be true disciples of Jesus Christ.



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2) DISCIPLES ARE _____ IN A SPIRITUAL WAR

a) The War

i) The war is being fought between the two ultimate forces in this universe: God and the Devil

ii) The war is being fought for the throne of God (Isa. 14:12-13; Rev. 12:7-9)

iii) The war is being fought for the souls of men (The life of Job; 2 Pet. 3:9; 1 Pet. 5:8)

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The Life of a Disciple

1) A disciple of Jesus Christ will always be involved in a pattern of growth. There are levels of maturity that we see in the Bible and we must constantly be evaluating where we are at and where it is that we want to be. If we are not growing then we are **regressing**, there is no staying the same. Today we will examine these levels of growth/maturity.

2) DISCIPLES ARE ALWAYS IN A PATTERN OF GROWTH

a) Babe in Christ

i) Doesn't have spiritual understanding, still thinks/lives carnally (1 Cor. 3:1)

(1) We need to be understanding of new Christians. They don't know a lot, they will still think and live carnally, they need patience and help; just like a newborn baby. A lot of patience and help and not high expectations

ii) Has a great hunger for the Word of God. They desire to learn and grow (1 Pet. 2:2)

(1) What they lack in understanding and maturity, they make up for in their hunger to learn and grow! They will soak up everything that they are taught, so we must be careful what we feed them/teach them

iii) Unskillful in understanding/explaining the Word of God. They need someone to help feed them and help them grow (Heb. 5:13)

(1) If they try to bite off more than they can chew from the Bible, it can be deadly for them. They need to stick to milk and foundational stuff and not be given too much until they are ready. They need discipled and someone to help them along until they are ready to feed themselves

b) Children

i) Have a hard time with selflessness/charity (1 Cor. 13:11; 1 Jn. 3:18)

(1) Children in Christ will have a hard time living charitably. They are still very dependent on others helping them along and are not ready to bear the burdens of others yet

ii) Know they are saved and know who their Father is (1 Jn. 2:12-13)

(1) They are still young in their faith and so they don't struggle with assurance of salvation. They know they are saved and they know they are in the family of God

iii) Still struggle with sin (1 Jn. 2:1; 2 Tim. 2:22; 1 Jn. 5:21)

(1) This is a common struggle for young Christians. Sin will keep you from being used by God and so the Devil really uses your youthfulness and immaturity to keep you in small sins that he knows will grow into larger ones. Especially beware of the sin of idolatry. Starting to become complacent and putting other things before God in your life.

c) Young Men/Women

i) Young men tend to be rash and quick to act. They know the Word of God well and they are strong in their faith. However, this makes them susceptible to attacks from the devil, false doctrines, and starting down the wrong path. They have overcome the childish sin in their lives (Titus 2:6-8; 1 Jn. 2:13-14)

ii) Young women are maturing to a point where they are becoming ready enough to be a godly helpmeet, mother, and home keeper. They are ready to bear the burdens of these responsibilities, unlike children. They are warned to not do anything that will shame God/her family. The devil turns the attack up on young women at this maturity level. Be ready (1 Tim. 5:14-15; Titus 2:4-5)

d) Fathers/Mothers

i) Fathers KNOW God. They are matured to a point where they don't doubt who God is, his existence, or what he is doing. They have proved him over and over (1 Jn. 2:13-14)

ii) They are patient, charitable, sound, and sober minded. They are under control and fully balanced in their Christian life. This takes a long time to learn and years of faithfulness and walking with God (Titus 2:2)

iii) Because of their spiritual maturity they are able to reproduce spiritually and make disciples. They are equipped to help others along

iv) Mothers are also balanced in their Christian lives. They are blameless in Christian conversation. They live lives that are discreet and not seeking glory for what they do. This will have a great reward in heaven (Luke 14:11). They are tasked with reproducing spiritually as well through teaching the younger women (Titus 2:3-5)

3) As a disciple of Jesus Christ we must always be growing. These maturity levels we see in the Bible are a good way for us to measure where we are at and if we are growing. Each of us needs to evaluate where we are at on this spectrum and where we want to be. We need to take the necessary steps to get to where we want to be and pick people who are further along to follow, but we must always keep **growing**!



The Life of a Disciple

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The Life of a Disciple

1) Today we will examine the different types of disciples we see in the Bible. There are many disciples but they all choose how close they will be to God and they are all at different levels of intimacy with God. We would all say we want to be close to God, but the truth is that not all of us are willing to do what it takes to make that happen. After today, it will be clear what it takes to be a disciple who is not just following Jesus, but **closer** to Jesus than anyone else.

2) **THERE ARE DIFFERENT LEVELS OF CLOSENESS TO GOD AMONG DISCIPLES**

   a) **The Multitudes**

      i) They will be fed the word of God (John 6:26)

      ii) They will experience miracles (Matt. 12:15)

      iii) They will walk away when things are tough (John 6:66; Jesus going to the cross)

      iv) They only follow for themselves and are not willing to sacrifice

         (1) When things are hard at all they are gone. They won't follow Jesus to his/their death

         (2) When Jesus says something they don't like, they are gone

         (3) When he calls them out for only living selfishly and not actually to follow him, they are gone

   b) **The Seventy**

      i) They will be involved in the work of the Lord. They will share his message and labor for him (Luke 10:1)

      ii) They will do miracles, not just experience them (Luke 10:17)

         (1) Being saved, leading someone to the Lord, discipling someone to walk closer with God, being conformed to the image of Jesus Christ through the reading of the word of God and prayer, these are all miracles!! Have you experienced miracles in your life?

      iii) While they truly desired to serve the Lord, they are not willing to do it once it costs them too much

         (1) As Jesus ministry progressed toward the cross, pressure and persecution built more and more. Things got harder and as we will see, the disciples that follow Jesus dwindle

         (2) We aren't told for certain what happens to these seventy (12 remained) but some potential things could be:

            (a) They feared what would happen to their family

            (b) They didn't like the ridicule they received from those they shared Jesus message with

            (c) They feared what would happen to their business (nobody would want to do business with some radicals following a radical teacher who was hated)

            (d) They feared that they may lose their lives

            (e) They realized they didn't have time to follow him EVERYWHERE he went because they had other things they were involved in. They had friends, activities, family, jobs, all good stuff that there was nothing wrong with. They weren't wiling to give it up.

            (f) They weren't willing to obey the "radical" things he was asking them to do (leave father and mother, leave family, not go back to bury your parents, forgive others, be in ministry with tax collectors and sinners, share his message that the kingdom was coming, etc…)

            (g) They weren't willing to let go of sin in their lives and simply felt unworthy to follow Jesus any further or share his message anymore

               (i) If you obey the Bible exactly as it says and exactly what is written to you today, YOU WILL BE CONSIDERED RADICAL, EVEN BY THOSE CLOSEST TO YOU

   c) **The Twelve**

      i) They are given power to preach and do miracles on Jesus behalf (Luke 9:1-2)

      ii) They are given special authority and power in eternity future for their service to God in this life (Matt. 19:28)

(1) You have this same ability to have this in eternity, but only if you are walking close to God like this. If you aren't a part of the "12" you won't be trusted with heavenly responsibility because he couldn't trust you with earthly responsibility

iii) They are shown some special things by God that the multitudes and the seventy will never be shown. God reveals special truths to them (Matt. 13:11)

iv) When things get tough they trust in God and pray, they don't run (Acts 1:13-14)

v) They do great things that will last for eternity for the Lord and will impact billions (Matthew, John, James, 1 & 2 Peter, 1 & 2 & 3 John, Jude, Revelation)

(1) These books were written by some of these 12 disciples and they will last for eternity and they have helped and impacted billions of people

vi) A small part of these 12 can be imposters and traitors (Matt. 26:47; Mark 14:10)

(1) It can be very easy to fake all of these things, but only for a season. Some that appear to be a part of this twelve will experience miracles, do miracles, be shown special revelation by God, etc… and yet they were faking it all along and they betray him

(a) At this level of discipleship you are following God in true charitable love for him. You cannot have this type of intimate relationship to God when you are just obeying on duty alone. Dutiful obedience is fine, but will only take you so far.

d) The Three

i) They will see the true full power and glory of Jesus (Matt. 17:1-9)

(1) There are many disciples who will serve and follow Jesus as far as he will take them but these 3 desired to KNOW HIM above all else. If you desire to know God like this, you will spend more time in his word and more time in prayer with him than anyone else. You only get to know Jesus the living Word this well through the written word. These disciples will see his glory and power in ways that so few will in their lives.

ii) Jesus depends on them and desires to have them near to him (Matt. 26:36-38)

(1) Would it hurt God's heart if you walked away? Do you have such a deep relationship with him that he desires for you to be the one near to him when things are hard? When the world is rejecting him, walking away from God, refusing to believe in him and thousands are heading to hell each day, does he look forward to his time with you, his faithful disciple he can count on

iii) They will see amazing miracles that even the other 12 will never see (Luke 8:49-56)

e) The One

i) They are so close to Jesus they KNOW they would never betray him; they have no doubt (John 13:23-25; Matt. 26:22)

ii) They will never walk away from Jesus. At risk of their life they will be with him all the way to the end, even when everyone else is gone (John 19:26)

(1) At this point, all others are gone. Even Peter, one of the 3, at this point had denied Jesus for fear of his own life. But John goes with him all the way to the cross

iii) God will show them unimaginable, amazing things that others will never understand. He reveals all truth to them and holds nothing back (Rev. 1:9-11; 10:4)

3) As we have seen today, there are many different levels to how closely we can walk with God. All of these people we have examined today were true disciples of Jesus, but not all disciples are the same. We can be as close to God as we desire to be, all we must do is make the choices that will make that possible. These are not easy choices but are well worth the amazing life that awaits when you are **the one** disciple among many disciples of Jesus Christ (*James 4:8- Draw nigh to God, and he will draw nigh to you..."*



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The Life of a Disciple

1) Today we will examine the part of the life of a disciple that nobody truly wants to experience, but we all must experience. If we are following Jesus as true disciples, we absolutely will and must **suffer**. This is a great way of knowing just how much of a disciple we are. The closer we are to Jesus, the more we will suffer.

2) THE SUFFERING OF A DISCIPLE

a) **DISCIPLES WILL SUFFER:**

i) **Persecution**- *2 Timothy 3:12- Yea, and all that will live godly in Christ Jesus shall suffer persecution.*

(1) (Matt. 10:22; Jn. 15:19; 16:33; 1 Thess. 3:2-4; 1 Pet. 4:12-13)

(a) This is just in general, we will all suffer troubles, battles, temptations, etc… this is a part of the life of a disciple

ii) **Physical danger/harm** (2 Cor. 11:23-27; Acts 7:59; 14:19; Jesus death and suffering; deaths of the disciples)

(1) **Bartholomew** was beaten with rods; and after having been thus scourged, to be beheaded.

(2) **James son of Alphaeus**, according to Fox's' Book of Martyrs, was beaten, stoned and clubbed to death.

(3) **Andrew** might have been martyred in Achaia or Patrae, both of which are places in the western part of Greece. According to the Catholic Encyclopedia, "It is generally agreed that he was crucified by order of the Roman Governor, Aegeas or Aegeates, at Patrae in Achaia, and that he was bound, not nailed, to the cross, in order to prolong his sufferings. The cross on which he suffered is commonly held to have been the decussate cross, now known as St. Andrew's, though the evidence for this view seems to be no older than the fourteenth century. His martyrdom took place during the reign of Nero

(4) **Peter** was crucified upside down in Rome during the 60s

(5) **John** was the last to be killed. It is said that he was boiled in oil but did not die, so they exiled him to the isle of Patmos where he was to die of natural causes. This is where he wrote Revelation and shortly thereafter died.

(6) **Thomas** was killed with a spear, according to Foxs' Book of Martyrs: "Called Didymus, preached the Gospel in Parthia and India, where exciting the rage of the pagan priests, he was martyred by being thrust through with a spear."

(7) The martyrdom of **James son of Zebedee** is recorded in the New Testament of the Bible, in Acts 12:1-2. He was executed, with a sword, by order of King Herod Agrippa I in the year 44 AD:

(8) **Matthew** was killed with a spear, according to Foxs' Book of Martyrs: "The scene of his labors was Parthia, and Ethiopia, in which latter country he suffered martyrdom, being slain with a halberd in the city of Nadabah, A.D. 60."

(9) **Jude** was crucified, according to Foxs' Book of Martyrs: "The brother of James, was commonly called Thaddeus. He was crucified at Edessa, A.D. 72."

(10) **Philip** was crucified, according to Foxs' Book of Martyrs: "He labored diligently in Upper Asia, and suffered martyrdom at Heliopolis, in Phrygia. He was scourged, thrown into prison, and afterwards crucified, A.D. 54.

(11) **Simon** was crucified, according to Foxs' Book of Martyrs: "Surnamed Zelotes, preached the Gospel in Mauritania, Africa, and even in Britain, in which latter country he was crucified, A.D. 74.

iii) Evil speaking (1 Pet. 2:12; 3:16; Matt. 5:11; Acts 7:54)

(1) People will speak evil of you and will gnash on your with their teeth when you are a disciple. This is the lost world, but quite honestly is even MORE THE CHRISTIAN WORLD. The devil will use them to hurt you the most. Those closest to you.

iv) The burdens of other believers (Gal. 6:2; Rom. 15:1; Eph. 4:1-3; 2 Cor. 11:28; 12:15)

(1) Paul puts this right up there with the physical harm he endured. He sees it as just as much of a problem for him. When we do this correctly, we will SUFFER for LONG time.

v) Temptation- *1 Corinthians 10:13- There hath no temptation taken you but such as is common to man: but God is faithful, who will not suffer you to be tempted above that ye are able; but will with the temptation also make a way to escape, that ye may be able to bear it.*

(a) (1 Pet. 1:6-7; James 1:12; Matt. 4:1,11)

3) As we have seen today, all disciples must suffer. While it is nothing that any of us enjoy, it shows us that we are doing something right for God. If we are not suffering, we are not **disciples**, and if we are suffering we are suffering for good reason. Ultimately we will all suffer as Christians, the question is whether we want to suffer now temporarily, or later in eternity (1 Cor. 3:15)



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3) As we have seen today, all disciples must suffer. While it is nothing that any of us enjoy, it shows us that we are doing something right for God. If we are not suffering, we are not _____, and if we are suffering we are suffering for good reason. Ultimately we will all suffer as Christians, the question is whether we want to suffer now temporarily, or later in eternity (1 Cor. 3:15)



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1) Today we will be looking at a very important part of the life of a disciple. Many Christians who are truly saved, spend little to no time communing with God. We are called to a relationship/walk with God and we cannot have this if we are not **talking** with God regularly. Disciples who truly follow Jesus Christ will talk with him, know him, and walk with him. Today we will examine some practical ways to do this in an effective way.

2) DISCIPLES COMMUNE WITH GOD

a) Talking to God

(1) Always begin your time with prayer. It will help get your heart/mind ready and prepare you to hear what God has to say to you. Even if it is just a quick prayer. Whatever you have time for.

ii) Get to a private/quiet place- Mark 1:35

iii) Ask for God to show you things out of his word – Psalm 119:18

iv) Ask for God to give you wisdom from his word- James 1:5

v) Ask for God to give you your "daily bread" from his word; exactly what you need to sustain you TODAY- Job 23:12; Matt. 6:11

vi) Ask for God to search you and show you the right way- Psalm 129:23-24

b) Hearing from God

(1) The way we hear from God, is through the word of God, the Bible

ii) Be alone and in a quiet place (Psa. 46:10; 1 Kings 19:12; 1 Thess. 4:11)

iii) Seek him early (Prov. 8:17; Exo. 16:11-21; Gen. 3:8)

iv) Be willing to "do" what God says and not just "hear" what he says (James 1:22-25; Matt. 7:24; John 13:17; Rom. 2:13)

v) Study the Bible for God to show you even more than you would get from just "reading" (2 Tim. 2:15; 1 Pet. 3:15; Acts 17:11)

vi) Meditate on what you read; think on it all during the day (Psa. 1:2; 119:15,97,99; Josh. 1:8)

3) As we have seen, the Bible shows us a lot about how we can commune with God. There are countless things we see in the Bible that we can take and directly apply to our lives that will help us commune with God. This is something that is required to be a true disciple of Jesus Christ, rather than just a "Christian" who has no real **relationship** with God.



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The Life of a Disciple

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2) BE NOT DECEIVED- Don't serve other gods

i) There are 5 times that this exact phrase, "be not deceived" shows up in your Bible. All of the verses are speaking to those who follow God as disciples. God uses this phrase sparingly in order to draw our attention to warn us! When we see it we must beware. Because of this, we will examine these warnings to disciples over the coming weeks.

b) Deut. 11:16- Take heed to yourselves, that your heart **be not deceived**, and ye turn aside, and serve other gods, and worship them;

i) This is the first commandment in the Bible (Exo. 20:3; Deut. 5:7)

ii) This is the GREAT commandment according to Jesus (Matt. 22:36-40; Deut. 6:5)

(1) Why is this the great commandment? Because like we have talked about in the past, if you love God above all else and put him first in your life, this takes care of ALL of lifes issues. You won't sin against him, you won't put other gods before him, you will spend time with him in prayer and in the Word of God, you will serve him, etc…)

iii) Young disciples are especially vulnerable to idol worship (1 John 5:21)

iv) What are examples of gods we see in our world today?

(1) Money, job, education, sports, music, theatre, celebrities, influencers, social media, phones, computers, video games, fleshly pleasures, sex, popularity, physical appearance, parents, spouse, girlfriend/boyfriend, friends, etc…

(a) A good way to know if you are treating something as a god/idol, a good way to know who your god is in your life, if you are putting other gods before the God, it to ask a few simple questions:

(i) Where Do I Spend My Time?

(ii) Where Do I Spend My Money?

(iii) Where Do I Get My Joy?

(iv) What's Always On My Mind?

v) God will tear down the idols in his temple (your life) if you will not because he is a jealous God (1 Cor. 6:19-20; 1 Samuel 5:1-5; Exo. 34:14; 20:5; Deut. 4:24; 5:9; 6:15; Josh. 24:19; Sng. 2:16; 6:3)

vi) FINAL WORD- Choose who you will serve today! (Joshua 24:14-15)

3) BE NOT DECEIVED- Beware of false Christs

a) Luke 21:8- And he said, Take heed that ye **be not deceived**: for many shall come in my name, saying, I am Christ; and the time draweth near: go ye not therefore after them.

(1) Most people do not think that this prophesy is really being fulfilled today because there aren't a bunch of people out there claiming to be the Messiah for Israel, however, as we will see today there are many false Christs that even true believers can at times follow after

b) Who Jesus Christ was and was NOT

i) He WAS God manifest in the flesh, who came to seek and save that which was lost (1 Tim. 3:16; John 1:1-3,14; Col. 2:8-9; John 3:16-18; 1 John 2:1-2; John 14:9; Luke 19:10)

ii) He was NOT just a lesser god, prophet, good man/teacher, etc..

(1) Liar, Lunatic, Lord

(2) Jehovah's Witness, Mormons,

(3) Charismatics (Faith Family and this Asbury University where so called "revival" is happening(a biblical revival looks like Acts 2, where the word of God is preached: judgment, doctrine, reproof, correction, and instruction in righteousness and thousands of people get saved and repent and start living lives for Christ, sharing the gospel and discipling. Not some emotion filled, feel good sing along with false tongues, false healings, false casting out of devils. It is all nonsense!) (show doctrine on screen and video)

(4) Campbellites ("First Christian" churches) (show on screen)

(5) Calvinists ("Reformed" Baptists, the chain of Chapel's like Green, NC, Wadsworth, Akron, etc…SHOW ON SCREEN)

(6) Jews, Muslims

(7) Catholics (Part 1, Section 2, Chapter 3, Article 10, lines 977 and 980 of the Vatican Roman Catholic Catechism "Our Lord tied the forgiveness of sins to faith and Baptism; It is through the sacrament of Penance that the baptized can be reconciled with God and with the Church") (show on screen)

iii) He WAS The Way, the Truth, and the Life

iv) He was NOT the false ways, truths, and lives that other ascribe to him

(1) FALSE WAY- Jesus Christ the social justice warrior (John 8:31-36; Acts 10:38)

(i) Jesus was THE WAY and pointed THE WAY to God. He never wasted time preaching about the injustices in government, treatment of social groups/classes. That is a false WAY.

(b) Jesus was a Jew under the rule of Rome: they were guaranteed no freedoms, forced to pay whatever taxes they were told, forced to obey whatever laws the king made, etc.. They were systemically OPPRESSED and under the fierce iron rod rule of Caesar. Yet Jesus NEVER fights for his rights, freedoms, speech, fair treatment under the law, etc… He is only concerned with the spiritual oppression of the world he created.

(2) FALSE TRUTH- Peace/Love only Jesus Christ (John 2:13-16; Mark 7:24-20; Matt. 23:13-26)

(i) Jesus was THE TRUTH and he spoke THE TRUTH that would lead people to everlasting life in him. He did not waste time lying to people to not hurt their feelings and just preach peace and love only as people died and went to hell around him. That is a false TRUTH.

(b) Matt. 23:13-36: He calls them:

(i) Hypocrites 7x

(ii) Children of Hell

(iii) Serpents

(iv) Vipers

(v) Blind Guides

(vi) White Sepulchers filled with dead men's bones

(vii) Murderers

(viii) Children of Murderers

(ix) He says "how can you escape the damnation of hell"

(x) Tells them they are full of iniquity

(xi) Tells them they stain at a gnat and swallow a camel

(c) Jesus was a preacher of TRUTH! He loved the sinners and repentant but despised the unrepentant religious leaders who led people away from the Lord. He was not a peace/love only God.

(3) FALSE LIFE- Jesus Christ the Humanitarian (Luke 4:40-44; 6:18-20; John 6:26-27)

(i) Jesus was the LIFE and preached to people how to have everlasting LIFE. He was not interested in just feeding the hungry, giving to the poor, healing the sick, etc.. and not using that as an opportunity to show them their need for everlasting life. This is a false LIFE.

(b) Jesus NEVER focused only on the humanistic needs of man. He did not come to just heal, feed, and give temporary physical comfort to people who were on their way to hell. He used these as signs for people to believe in him and his message of eternal life through him!

4) As we have seen today, God gives warning all over the Bible to his disciples to not be deceived. He uses this phrase sparingly to bring our attention to it and to learn to be on the look out. These deceptions was saw today are so subtle and so **PREVALENT** in our world today. We can all be guilty of falling into these deceptions at times, but if we are going to be successful disciples of Jesus Christ, we must heed our masters warning and not be deceived by idolatry and false Christs if we are going to bring glory to God in our lives.



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The Life of a Disciple

1) Today we will be looking at two more warnings given from God's word about not being deceived as disciples. If we are going to live successfully as disciples of Jesus Christ in this world, then we must heed these **warnings** that God is drawing our attention to and make proper adjustments in our lives where they are needed.
2) **BE NOT DECEIVED- Evil communications corrupt good manners**
3) 1 Cor. 15:33- *Be not deceived: evil communications corrupt good manners.*
   - ***a)*** **In the context, bad doctrine/teachings will corrupt your actions**
     - *i)* Vs. 12-17,32- This church was falling into a false teaching that Jesus did not rise from the dead. Paul writes this to them to tell them that he did, he had to, and then gives this warning (Matthew 7:21-23; Rom. 10:1-2; Gal. 1:11-14; Acts 18:24-28)
       - *(1)* Doctrine (beliefs) effect what you do. That is why we emphasize good doctrine so much because it is what steers what you do, who you are, your lifestyle, your ministry, etc…Paul even says that if Christ did not rise from the dead, forget sacrifice, forget preaching the gospel, forget this whole Christian life; eat, drink, do what you want because tomorrow we die and it all didn't matter!
       - *(2)* Explain Historical to Doctrinal to Devotional pattern that must be followed
     - ii) **Devotionally, we also see that evil communications (what we say, hear, who we hang out with, etc…) will corrupt how we live (2 Pet. 2:7-8; Job 31:1; Gen 6:2; 2 Sam. 11:2-4; Prov. 4:25-27; Gen. 13:10-13)**
       - *(1)* Notice the connection God makes with what we see, hear, who we are with, etc.. all non physical things that effect how we behave and live. Don't miss it, they are connected and evil communications will corrupt good manners (actions and how you live) (*be careful little eyes what you see, be careful little ears what you hear)*
4) **BE NOT DECEIVED- The unrighteous shall not inherit the Kingdom of God**
5) 1 Cor. 6:9-11- *Know ye not that the unrighteous shall not inherit the kingdom of God? **Be not deceived**: neither fornicators, nor idolaters, nor adulterers, nor effeminate, nor abusers of themselves with mankind, Nor thieves, nor covetous, nor drunkards, nor revilers, nor extortioners, shall inherit the kingdom of God. And such were some of you: but ye are washed, but ye are sanctified, but ye are justified in the name of the Lord Jesus, and by the Spirit of our God.*
   - **a) The Kingdom of God** (Lk. 17:21; Romans 14:17; John 3:3)
     - i) When you receive Jesus Christ as your savior and you are born again, the kingdom of God now resides within you
     - ii) That is why when Paul is contrasting the unrighteous and the believers in this chapter, he is saying "why are you letting the unrighteous judge your legal matters? Don't you know that you will be judges of greater things in the future? The unrighteous won't inherit the kingdom of God because they are these things (list of sins)"

b) What the unrighteous do

i) **Fornicators**- The incontinence or lewdness of unmarried persons, male or female; also, the criminal conversation of a married man with an unmarried woman. (1 Cor. 5:1)

ii) **Idolaters**- A worshiper of idols; one who pays divine honors to images, statues, or representations of any thing made by hands; one who worships as a deity that which is not God; a pagan.

iii) **Adulterers**- Violation of the marriage bed; a crime, or a civil injury, which introduces, or may introduce, into a family, a spurious offspring.

iv) **Effeminate**- Having the qualities of the female sex; soft or delicate to an unmanly degree; tender; womanish; voluptuous.

v) **Abusers of themselves with mankind**- *arsenokoitēs*; one who lies with a male as with a female, sodomite, homosexual (same word as in 1 Tim. 1:10, same context of type of sin)

vi) **Thieves**- Those who commit the act of stealing. In law, the private, unlawful, felonious taking of another person's goods or movables, with an intent to steal them.

vii) **Covetous**- Those who desire inordinately; to desire that which it is unlawful to obtain or possess; in a bad sense.

viii) **Drunkard**- One given to ebriety or an excessive use of strong liquor; a person who habitually or frequently is drunk.

ix) **Revilers**- Those who reproach; to treat with opprobrious and contemptuous language.

x) **Extortioners**- Anyone who commits the act of extorting; the act or practice of wresting any thing from a person by force, duress, menaces, authority, or by any undue exercise of power; illegal exaction; illegal compulsion to pay money, or to do some other act.

c) Are you unrighteous?

i) Are you saved but just living in the flesh? (Gal. 5:16-26; Rom. 7:14-25)

(1) Walk in the Spirit and you won't fulfill the lusts of the flesh

(a) Read the word of God daily (Eph. 6:17; Eph. 5:26; John 17:17)

(b) Pray about and Obey what God is telling you to do; EVERY day (Matthew 26:41)

ii) OR, are you still unsaved?

(1) Have you ever had a moment in your life where you prayed to receive the gift of salvation through the death, burial, and resurrection of Jesus Christ? (Romans 10:9,13; 1 Cor. 15:1-4)

6) As we have seen today, God is trying to warn us about living like the unrighteous and what communications we have in our lives. No doubt these two warnings are connected because when we allow evil communications in our lives, we will end up living like the unrighteous. This will cause a host of issues in our lives and cause us to doubt salvation, make fleshly decisions, and ultimately live **fruitless** lives as disciples. We all ought to listen to our Lord's plee and be not deceived by these things in order to live lives that bring God glory as his disciples.



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1) Today we will examine the final warning God gives to disciples to not be deceived by in this world. This warning is the most somber and probably the most important to our every day lives. If we can take hold of this warning we are getting today, it will take care of a host of issues in our lives and allow us to live **successfully** as his disciples.
2) **BE NOT DECEIVED- You will reap what you sow**
3) Gal. 6:7-9 *Be not deceived; God is not mocked: for whatsoever a man soweth, that shall he also reap. For he that soweth to his flesh shall of the flesh reap corruption; but he that soweth to the Spirit shall of the Spirit reap life everlasting. And let us not be weary in well doing: for in due season we shall reap, if we faint not.*
   a) We know exactly what will come from what we are sowing
      (1) There are no surprises. God is not mocked, you will receive exactly what you are sowing. Would you act surprised if you sowed apple seeds in a field and an apple tree came from them? Of course not! It is the same in our lives, expect the end of what you are sowing to be exactly what God says it will be
      (2) There are only two things that we can sow in this world, there are no exceptions! Paul tells us what they both are and the result of each.
   ii) Flesh ⟶ Corruption
      (1) Eternal Corruption for those you won't reach (Acts 2:31: 1 Cor. 15:50)
         (a) When you are living in your flesh, you are not sowing the seed of the gospel and peoples souls will suffer for eternity because of it. Most likely those closest to you will suffer for all of eternity because of it.
      (2) Corruption/Death in your life (Rom. 5:12; 6:21,23; 7:5; 8:6,13; Jam. 1:15; Prov. 22:8)
         (a) What does this look like in real life? Loneliness, depression, hopelessness, no directions in life, no drive in life, nothing to get you up each day, trouble understanding the Bible, not seeing answers to prayers, emptiness (vanity), physical ailments/issues (see 1 Cor. 6:18), miserable life (2 Pet. 2:20-22)
      (3) How do we live in the flesh? (Gal. 5:19-21)
         (a) Living in the flesh does not always have to be expressly stated sin but just living for what feels good to you. We ought to be in the habbit of living our lives for others, denying ourselves, denying our flesh, taking up our cross daily and dying to ourselves daily. This means even when you have the "right" to do something that you want to do because it is good for you, you live for others and not for your flesh.
   iii) Spirit ⟶ Life Everlasting
      (1) Eternal Life for those around you that you reach with the gospel (Rom. 1:9; 15:19; Luke 4:18)
         (a) When you are living in the Spirit, you will be ready to preach the gospel and you will desire to share the gospel. This will lead to life everlasting for many around you!

(2) A full life with Jesus Christ today (Gal. 5:22-23; Rom. 8:1)

(a) This is the life that everyone desires. It won't be perfect, it will be full of persecution, but will a greater purpose and peace. You will have clear direction, you will hear from God in his word, you will see answered prayers, people get saved, peoples lives change, those around you will be better off

(b) Whatever you sow, you will reap! Time in the Bible/prayer vs sleeping in. Sharing the gospel vs not. Discipling vs not. Mercy, you will be shown mercy. Anger, you will have a chaotic and angry life. Peace, you will have peace in life, etc…

(3) How do we live in the Spirit?

(a) Spend time in the word of God (Jn. 17:17; 16:13; 1 Cor. 2:10-11)

(b) Spend time in prayer (Rom. 8:26-27; Eph. 2:18)

(c) Mortify the deeds of the flesh and mind the things of the Spirit (Rom. 8:5,13)

(i) When you are minding the things that the spirit of God cares about, you are walking in the spirit. (Souls, the gospel, the word of God, bringing glory to God, etc..)

(ii) When you are mortifying what your flesh desires, you are walking in the spirit. This can even be "good things" that are necessarily wrong but just what feeds your fleshes desires. (this is a big part of fasting, it is just another way to deny your flesh and allow the spirit of God to have more reign in your body)

b) We DO NOT know exactly how much we will sow from what we reap

(1) When you plant a seed, do you always just get 1 single piece of fruit? No! Usually you get multitudes of fruit from one seed!

ii) There can be great amounts of good fruit that come from one small seed (Matthew 13:3-8)

(1) Tell story of Mark Trotter and his fruit tree

(2) Tell Story of Pastor Tom and his fruit tree

(3) Tell Story of Pastor Jay and his fruit tree

(4) Tell Story of Howard Hendricks and his fruit tree

iii) There can be great amounts of bad fruit that come from one small bad seed (Matthew 7:15-20; 12:33)

(1) Multitudes of fruit can come from one seed, good or bad; and there are bad and good examples of trees/fruit in the Bible

(2) Don't ever make the mistake of thinking that your actions don't matter. Don't think you know the outcome of the decisions you make. They grow into a huge tree of effects that you could never have imagined; for good and bad

4) As we have seen today, God emphasizes this issue of flesh vs. spirit in his word. The bottom line is that as disciples, each and every day, sometimes without even knowing it, we are sowing something. It is our job to heed the warning of our Lord and make sure we are sowing what will reap life everlasting and not corruption. This will ultimately put us on the path to living as **true** disciples of Jesus Christ, who follow in Jesus's footsteps and bring glory to God.



The Life of a Disciple

1) Today we will examine the final warning God gives to disciples to not be deceived by in this world. This warning is the most somber and probably the most important to our every day lives. If we can take hold of this warning we are getting today, it will take care of a host of issues in our lives and allow us to live _____ as his disciples.
2) **BE NOT DECEIVED- You _____ reap what you sow**
3) Gal. 6:7-9 *Be not deceived; God is not mocked: for whatsoever a man soweth, that shall he also reap. For he that soweth to his flesh shall of the flesh reap corruption; but he that soweth to the Spirit shall of the Spirit reap life everlasting. And let us not be weary in well doing: for in due season we shall reap, if we faint not.*
   a) We know exactly what will come from what we are sowing
      i) Flesh ⟹ Corruption
         (1) Eternal Corruption for those you won't reach (Acts 2:31: 1 Cor. 15:50)
         (2) Corruption/Death in your life (Rom. 5:12; 6:21,23; 7:5; 8:6,13; Jam. 1:15; Prov. 22:8)
         (3) How do we live in the flesh? (Gal. 5:19-21)
      ii) Spirit ⟹ Life Everlasting
         (1) Eternal Life for those around you that you reach with the gospel (Rom. 1:9; 15:19; Luke 4:18)
         (2) A full life with Jesus Christ today (Gal. 5:22-23; Rom. 8:1)
         (3) How do we live in the Spirit?
            (a) Spend time in the word of God (Jn. 17:17; 16:13; 1 Cor. 2:10-11)
            (b) Spend time in prayer (Rom. 8:26-27; Eph. 2:18)
            (c) Mortify the deeds of the flesh and mind the things of the Spirit (Rom. 8:5,13)
   b) We DO NOT know exactly how much we will sow from what we reap
      i) There can be great amounts of good fruit that come from one small seed (Matthew 13:3-8)
      ii) There can be great amounts of bad fruit that come from one small bad seed (Matthew 7:15-20; 12:33)
4) As we have seen today, God emphasizes this issue of flesh vs. spirit in his word. The bottom line is that as disciples, each and every day, sometimes without even knowing it, we are sowing something. It is our job to heed the warning of our Lord and make sure we are sowing what will reap life everlasting and not corruption. This will ultimately put us on the path to living as _____ disciples of Jesus Christ, who follow in Jesus's footsteps and bring glory to God.